

WEEK 1 OF 4 · Breath

Script 1: Finding the Breath**Theme: Attention and Focus**

Rationale: Breathing is a natural tool we often ignore. Practicing breath awareness helps students increase their attention and harness energy for harmonious movement.

Request that students find their meditation stance. Remind students: "If at any point this exercise becomes too uncomfortable or you need to take a break, please do so."

"We are going to start with something we do naturally and often without thinking: breathing. We will take a few moments to tune into our breath and how it affects our mind and body. Take a moment to settle into your meditation stance. Feel your body aligned with the ground. You can close your eyes if you feel comfortable, or simply lower your gaze toward the floor.

Once your body has settled, gently bring your attention to your breath. You don't have to change anything about it; just breathe as you normally would. (Pause for 10 seconds.)

Now, I'd like you to notice the 'shape' of your breath. See if you can notice where your breath begins... and where it ends. See if you can notice the middle of the breath. As you follow the breath, let the mind go and the body relax. Try this for three full breaths. (Pause for 15 seconds.)

You may notice your mind wandering or getting lost in thought. That is okay. Gently bring your mind back to your breath each time it wanders off. Try five more breaths. (Pause for 30 seconds.)

If your attention floats away, gently and compassionately come back to the breath. When you are ready, slowly bring your attention back to the room and open your eyes."